



Crazy airport stories

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Agent 001

Exynos or Snapdragon?

Dear Agent001,

I want to buy a Samsung Galaxy Note 4 but I am confused whether to go for the Exynos or the Snapdragon variant. So please help me by giving your precious advice. Thank You.

– Shrikant Kalar

A Hey Shrikant,

Exynos SoCs used to be way powerful about 2 years back but Qualcomm has caught up since then and the Snapdragon 805 now performs equally good if not better than the Exynos 5433. Depending on which benchmark you run either the Exynos variant or the Snapdragon variant will come out ahead and that too by a slight margin.

Check the GeekBench3 scores here: <http://dgit.in/SamN4Exy-VsSnap>. Snapdragon is ahead in this one but if you check out AnTuTu scores then the Exynos variant comes out ahead. When it comes to custom ROMs then Snapdragon SoCs seem to have been favoured a lot more than Exynos variants in the past but it's not a given that the same could be said for current generation of SoCs.

Security-wise, there have been reports of vulnerabilities in both SoCs and that's something which isn't going to change at all. So if you wish to fiddle around with your phone and install custom ROMs then the Snapdragon variant seems to be preferable but if you want to make use of the 64-bit computing power of the Exynos (which is expected to improve with the Lollipop 5.0 update) then by all means you can go ahead with the Exynos 5433.

You might want to watch a few videos to help you make up your mind and also to figure out if that meagre difference in performance between the two variants is something that you're worried about. Most people wouldn't even be able to tell the difference but if you're going to plunk down a sizeable amount for the Note 4 then you need to experience them both.

Digital camera for ₹30,000

Hi Digit!

I'm one of your magazine's biggest fan. Since my childhood I have been fascinated by photography. Now I have got a chance to buy a digital camera. Please suggest me a best one to buy including lens. My budget is around ₹30,000. Please guide me. Thank you.

– Anish Angadi

A Hi Anish,

Considering your budget, I'd say that the best option for you will be the Nikon D5100 and a Nikon Nikkor 50mm f/1.8 lens. The camera should set you back by about ₹24,000, if you keep an eye out on sites like Amazon and eBay, and the lens should be available for around ₹7,000. If not you can wait for the next sale and you'd definitely get it for this much or even lesser. This is an excellent bundle for beginners and the 50mm will be particularly useful for portraits and macro shots, as well as night photography. Good hunting! 

GAME DESIGNERS: MORE THAN MEETS THE EYE

Look around you. You may be in a bus, on a train or in a busy lift on your way to the office, ninth floor. Wherever you look, people scan-read screens, play games, follow directions to the next turn to their destination or the next station on their commute. Wherever you look, you can see people being guided and taken through interfaces — whether digital or physical — leading them in a flow to their next purchase or destination. Wherever you look, you see design is everywhere.

The times, they are a changin', says the song. The back and forth interaction between those screens and their end users, the heads-up-displays, the branching narratives, the progression curves, the learning curves — all notions familiar to game designers. All notions in which we thrive and excel, have now become increasingly pervasive.

Pervasive to such an extent that industrial designers, e-learning companies, marketing and advertising managers are now using them on a daily basis, though lacking the skills to tackle them in most of the cases. We can't blame them

for these skills are rather difficult to be found in the different sectors of the job market they're shuffling through. Thing is, they didn't look for them in the right place, the video game design job market — for who knows these mechanisms better than game designers?

The cultural shock is happening right now at a low intensity, as the industry at large understand that gaming might mean much more than just shooting zombies and crushing candies and the gaming professionals begin to realize on their side that they might be useful in very, very diverse areas. McDonald's Monopoly? Gaming. Promotional game for the Air Force? Gaming. Loyalty achievements for the clients of a mall? Gaming. Teaching English to kids through interactive stories? Gaming. Building an application that lets you visit museums with your iPad? Gaming. Immersive documentaries? Gaming.

Game design indeed — with all the fields of interaction design, digital storytelling, e-training that it encompasses. It's about time to find ourselves a new, broader name and to fill in the roles in which the industry needs us.

Article written by Patrice Crespy, who is a Game Design Trainer at the Rubika Supinfogame School. He's been a Lead Game Designer and Producer for several years, a critically-acclaimed writer of fantasy novels and roleplaying games, a politics storyteller and a Serious Game Designer. For more information, visit www.dsksic.com.

